Econ 101: Introduction to Microeconomics

MTWRF 12:00 pm - 1:45 pm **Location and Room: PRN 324A**
Section(s): 11, Credits: 3
Semester: Winter, 2024

In-person Office Hours**: MWF 10 am - 11 am, TR 3 pm - 4 pm PRN 333G** or by appointment fgentile@udel.edu

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1. Instructor Information and Introduction

Instructor Contact Information

Instructor name: Frank Gentile
Instructor pronouns: He / him
Email address: fgentile@udel.edu
Canvas course site: https://udel.instructure.com/courses/1759466
Website: https://uptownfrunk.substack.com/
Office location: PRN 333G
Office hours: MWF 10 am - 11 am, TR 3 pm - 4 pm or by appointment

About the Instructor:

Your instructor, Frank Gentile, is a PhD student in the economics department at the University of Delaware specializing in industrial organization, development economics, and energy transition. He graduated from the Pennsylvania State University with a degree in chemical engineering with honors, and minors in economics and mathematics. He has worked in the energy industry for a large multinational corporation as well as an intergovernmental organization and holds a masters of science degree in economics and finance from King's College London.

Frank has taught introductory level macroeconomics, as well as graduate level macroeconomics and econometrics while at the University of Delaware. He has taught game theory, thermodynamics and heat transfer while at Penn State. He is passionate about teaching and is invested in the academic and professional success of his students.

In his free time, Frank enjoys sports, traveling, cooking, and outdoor activities like hiking. His favorite economics podcasts include Marketplace with host Kai Ryssdal, Planet Money, Slate Money, Capitalisn't, and Volts.

2. Course Description

Course Catalog Description

Introduces supply and demand concepts with basic economic graphs. Examines models of perfect and imperfect competition and determinants of production price and quantity. Covers microeconomic issues such as the effect of government regulation and environmental problems. CO-REQ: One of the following: MATH 114, MATH 115, or MATH 117; or students must achieve placement into MATH 221 or MATH 241 on the Math Placement Exam. See https://www.mathsci.udel.edu/courses-placement/ud-math-placement/placement-goal for more information.

Course Delivery

- The traditional lecture approach to teaching is an excellent way to transfer information from one notebook to another. However, understanding the material requires a more hands-on approach to learning where you actively engage in the learning process. This necessitates you come to class prepared and continue your engagement with the material outside the class meeting times. The format of this course is designed to encourage your involvement by combining a problem-based introduction to concepts with worked exercises.
- This course emphasizes economic thinking. We will study microeconomic concepts and techniques, and we will apply them to a variety of contexts. We will employ collaborative and reflective learning methods. You are encouraged to contribute your ideas and thoughts.
- Students should remain alert, ask relevant questions, participate in group discussions, and respectfully listen and respond to each other and the instructor in their words and actions.
- The instructor expects you to engage with the material during each class and each discussion session. If you engage in disruptive behavior, the instructor will ask you to leave, and you will forfeit any points associated with graded work on that day.

University/College/Department Requirements this Course Meets

Approved for University Breadth Requirement

3. Learning Outcomes

By the end of the course, successful students will be able to

1. Demonstrate their understanding of foundational microeconomic terms and concepts (e.g., opportunity cost, comparative advantage, demand, supply, market equilibrium, efficiency, government market intervention, and market structures).
2. Identify and connect microeconomic concepts to current events.
3. Develop critical thinking skills by formulating solution strategies for applied microeconomic problems.
4. Develop analytical skills using graphs and simple algebra to analyze real-world microeconomic problems.

4. Learning Resources

Required Learning Materials

This course requires the following primary resources:

1. Pearson MyLab Bundle
    A. Textbook: *Microeconomics*, 8th updated edition by Hubbard and O'Brien (Pearson)
    B. Access to Pearson *MyLab Economics* (MyLab) - the online homework system, and
    C. Access to Pearson *Learning Catalytics* (LC) - the in-class participation system
2. A paper notebook and writing utensils
3. Access to a printer.

The instructor will post redacted lecture notes for each course module in advance. These redacted notes facilitate your note-taking. Print them beforehand and bring them to class.

The lectures are mainly based on the readings from the textbook; however, the coverage of material in class may expand beyond the textbook readings. Reading the textbook chapters is critical to comprehending the material but is not a substitute for taking quality notes in class.

Digital Delivery

The Pearson MyLab Bundle is available as an eText bundle through "Digital Delivery," which gives you access to the required MyLab resources via Canvas at the start of the semester. The bundle costs $109.99, and the University will directly charge your University account one day after the add/drop deadline. If you drop the course, you will not be billed.

- If you opt out of Digital Delivery or drop the class by the add/drop date, you will NOT receive a charge on your University Account, and your access to the course resources will be deactivated.
- Contact the University bookstore for details on how to opt out of Digital Delivery.

To gain access, follow the registration instructions below.

You do NOT need to purchase any textbook for this course unless you desire an optional loose-leaf book.

MyLab Registration and Access

Follow the following steps to register for MyLab and obtain access to the MyLab bundle. The procedure will link MyLab to this Canvas course.

1. Click on the MyLab and Mastering tab in the course menu and select any course link on the Pearson page.
2. When prompted, accept the End-User License Agreement and privacy policy.
3. When you see the "Link your accounts" page, create a Pearson MyLab account by selecting "Create an account." Follow the instructions. You must use your UD email address for your Pearson account to receive credit for your online homework assignments and in-class exercises.
    - Note. If you already have a Pearson MyLab account registered with your UD email address, do NOT register. Instead, enter your Pearson account username and password.
4. When asked to choose how to access the course, select the "Use an Access Code" option. Enter the following access code: **HSCOEE-NAIAD-NATCH-PAMPA-TANIS-GALES**
5. After you have submitted the access code, you should see the "You're Done" page.

Trouble-Shooting

If you are receiving an error message suggesting that you cannot access the course, please follow these steps:

1. Verify your computer meets the system requirements (Operating Systems and Browsers, Browser Settings, etc.) at the following website: https://mlm.pearson.com/northamerica/myeconlab/system-requirements/index.html
2. For additional help, go to the following website: https://help.pearsoncmg.com/integration/cg/student/content/get_started.htm
3. If you chose the temporary access and want to change it to full access, please visit the following website: https://support.pearson.com/getsupport/s/article/MyLab-Mastering-Change-Temporary-Access-to-Full-Access
4. If you need to change your MyLab account email address, go to the MyLab Course Home page. (Modules > Resources > MyLab Course Home.)
    - Locate your name in the top-right corner and click on it. Then, click "Account" to access your MyLab profile.
    - Click "Edit" next to your email address and change it to match your UD email address.

Optional Loose-Leaf Print Upgrade

A discounted loose-leaf book is available for purchase through the publisher's website at a discounted price of $39.99 for students who purchased the MyLab Bundle.

To order the loose-leaf upgrade, please visit the following website:
https://www.pearson.com/en-us/subject-catalog/p/microeconomics/P200000005936/9780135952504

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Canvas Integration

The instructor will use Canvas (UD's online learning management platform) to post assignments and other course materials. You can access the MyLab resources through Canvas.

Technology

Canvas: In this class, Canvas, UD's online learning management system, will be used for all course activities and communication channels. All assignments will be posted through the Canvas course site unless otherwise directed. Information on how to use Canvas is available through the Canvas Student Guide. Canvas can also be accessed via MyUD.

Zoom: In this class, Zoom will be used for video conferencing. You will receive a meeting invitation with a specific web link and meeting ID number for use in this class. Zoom is a web-based application that can be used from a computer, tablet, or phone. From a computer, click the class web link and be sure to install the small program that will download to your computer. You only need to install the program once. From a mobile device, download the free Zoom app and type in the class meeting ID number. A microphone and camera are recommended for online meetings. Information on how to test your computer's audio and video can be found on Zoom's website. Learn more info about Zoom at UD.

5. Tips for Success

You Are in the Driver's Seat of Your Success. Drive Responsibly.

- Come to class and come prepared (review the Study Guide and read the textbook sections).
- Take quality notes during each class and focus on the material.
- Work through your notes from the previous lecture and rework practice problems.
- Focus on understanding the concepts rather than memorizing them.
- Practice your understanding.
- Balance your priorities and take responsibility for your actions (or inactions).

Keep Up. The Material Builds on Itself.

- The instructor will only share redacted lecture notes on Canvas (typically at the beginning of the week). If you miss a class, obtain lecture notes from a classmate.
- Complete the readings for each lecture.
- Stay alert and ask questions. Don't get discouraged if some material seems abstract at first.
- Participate in the in-class exercises.
- Attend office hours. (Come with questions about the lectures and textbook material.)

Engage with the Material Outside of Class.

- Start the assignments early. Consult your lecture notes and the textbook. Actively engage with the problems to learn the material.
- Form study groups.

- Use the features of the MyLab learning platform to help you learn: the interactive eText, the Study Plan with access to many additional practice problems (end-of-chapter problems), and chapter quizzes, ...
- Be organized.

6. Learning Assessment

Final Grade Breakdown

The final course grade will be calculated using the following components:

Course Component	Percentage of Total
Attendance	10%
Participation	15%
Homework	35%
Exam 1	10%
Exam 2	10%
Final Exam (Cumulative)	20%

Attendance

Your consistent attendance is vital for your success in this accelerated course. You are strongly encouraged to attend all scheduled classes, recognizing that the fast-paced nature of this course makes each session essential for understanding key concepts. Missing lectures will result in significant gaps in your comprehension of the material. If you miss class, please email me ahead of time and retrieve notes from a classmate or during office hours.

Participation

Active participation in class discussions and exercises is a crucial component of your learning experience in this course. Beyond attendance, we encourage you to fully engage with the material and your peers. Applying economic concepts to real-life situations enhances your understanding, and we welcome you to share your experiences during class discussions.

Guidelines for Participation:

- Attend class regularly and actively participate in discussions and exercises.
- Apply economic principles to real-world scenarios and bring these experiences into class discussions.

Encouragement for Active Engagement:

- Pose questions, provide answers, and actively contribute to class conversations.
- Collaborate with classmates by offering assistance and sharing insights.

Learning through Interaction:

- Actively engaging with the material and your peers fosters a deeper understanding of economic concepts.
- Participation is not solely about being physically present but actively contributing to the learning environment.

Embracing Learning Opportunities:

- Do not hesitate to participate, even if you feel uncertain. Every interaction is a valuable learning opportunity.
- Your involvement in discussions, questions, and exercises is integral to the success of the course.
- Your active participation contributes to a dynamic and enriching learning environment for everyone in the class.

Homework

Homework assignments will be facilitated and assessed using Pearson MyLab, accessible both through Canvas and externally. These assignments are due by midnight on the specified due dates. While the deadline is firm, it is strongly advised that students commence these assignments early to allow ample time for questions and clarifications.

Submission Platform	Pearson MyLab, accessible via Canvas or externally
Due Dates	All homework assignments are due on Tuesdays and Thursdays
Submission Time	Due by midnight on respective due dates (late work not accepted)
Preparation and Questions	Students are encouraged to start their assignments well in advance and attend office hours with any questions to seek clarification on challenging concepts
Grading	Homework assignments will be graded based on accuracy
Dropped Homework	One homework score will be dropped to accommodate unforeseen circumstances

These homework assignments are designed to enhance your understanding of the course material. Consistent engagement and timely completion will contribute significantly to your success. Should you encounter any challenges or have questions, do not hesitate to reach out during office hours or via email for assistance.

Exams

The assessments for this course will consist of both multiple-choice and short-answer questions. Approximately 80% of each exam will be dedicated to multiple-choice questions, while the remaining 20% will involve short-answer components. All exams will be conducted on paper during regular class hours, except for the final exam.

Exam Dates:

Midterm Exam 1: Friday, January 12, 2024
Midterm Exam 2: Friday, January 26, 2024
Final Exam: Friday, February 2, 2024 in class

Cumulative Nature of the Final Exam:

The final exam will cover a comprehensive range of topics, with an equitable distribution of material from Exam 1 and Exam 2 and will also include material covered after the second midterm. This approach ensures that your understanding of both midterm assessments contributes to your success in the final examination.

Please make a note of these dates and plan your schedule accordingly. If you have any concerns about the examination format or scheduling, do not hesitate to discuss them during office hours or via email. Your preparation and engagement in the examination process are essential for a meaningful learning experience in this course.

Grading Scale

Students will be assigned the following letter grade based on the calculation coming from the course assessment section.

Grade	Interval
A	94.0 and above
A-	90.0 to <94.0
B+	87.0 to <90.0
B	84.0 to <87.0
B-	80.0 to <84.0
C+	77.0 to <80.0
C	74.0 to <77.0
C-	70.0 to <74.0
D+	67.0 to <70.0
D	64.0 to <67.0
D-	61.0 to <64.0
F	<61.0
Z	*Unofficial withdraw. Applicable to students who never attended/participated or stopped attending/participating.*

7. Course Calendar

Day of Week	Date	Topic	Subtopics	Related Chapter	Due
Wednesday	01/03/24	Introduction & Syllabus & Foundations and Models	Foundations and Models: Three Key Economic Ideas, Economic Models	1	
Thursday	01/04/24	Foundations and Models	Economic Terms, Using Graphs and Formulas	1	Getting Started
Friday	01/05/24	Trade-Offs, Comparative Advantage, and the Market System	Production Possibilities Frontier, Opportunity Cost, Absolute Advantage	2	
Saturday	01/06/24				
Sunday	01/07/24				
Monday	01/08/24	Trade-Offs, Comparative Advantage, and the Market System & The Interaction of Demand and Supply	Comparative Advantage, Gains from Trade, Market System & Demand Side, Supply Side	2/3	***Last Day to Drop Add***
Tuesday	01/09/24	The Interaction of Demand and Supply	Market Equilibrium, Effect of Demand and Supply Shifts on Equilibrium	3	Chapter 1 & 2 Homework
Wednesday	01/10/24	Economic Efficiency, Government Price Setting, and Taxes	Consumer Surplus and Producers Surplus, Willingness to Pay, Willingness to Accept, Marginal Benefit, Marginal Cost, Total Benefit, Total Cost, Efficiency	4	
Thursday	01/11/24	Economic Efficiency, Government Price Setting, and Taxes	Price Floors and Price Ceilings; Economic Effect of Taxes, Quantitative Demand and Supply Analysis	4	Chapter 3 & 4 Homework
Friday	**01/12/24**	**Exam 1**		**1,2,3,4**	
Saturday	01/13/24				
Sunday	01/14/24				
Monday	01/15/24	No Classes - MLK Day			
Tuesday	01/16/24	Externalities, Environmental Policy, and Public Goods	Negative and Positive Externalities, Market Failure, Deadweight Loss	5	
Wednesday	01/17/24	Externalities, Environmental Policy, and Public Goods	Solutions to Externalities: Coase Theorem, Government Policies; Four Categories of Goods	5	

Thursday	01/18/24	Elasticity: The Responsiveness of Demand and Supply	Price Elasticity of Demand, Calculating and Interpreting the Price Elasticity, Elasticity of Demand of Linear Demand	6	Chapter 5 Homework
Friday	01/19/24	Elasticity: The Responsiveness of Demand and Supply	Relationship between Price Elasticity of Demand and Total Revenue, Other Demand Elasticities, Price Elasticity of Supply	6	
Saturday	01/20/24				
Sunday	01/21/24				
Monday	01/22/24	Consumer Choice	Utility and Consumer Decision Making, Where Demand Curves Come From	10	
Tuesday	01/23/24	Consumer Choice & Technology, Production, and Costs	Indifference Curves and Budget Sets (Lines) & Technology, Short Run and Long Run, Marginal Product of Labor, Average Product of Labor	10/11	Chapter 6 & 10 Homework
Wednesday	01/24/24	Technology, Production, and Costs	Relationship between SR and LR Cost, Graphing Cost Curves: MC, TC, ATC, AVC, AFC	11	
Thursday	01/25/24	Firms in Perfectly Competitive Markets	Perfectly Competitive Markets, How a Firm Maximizes Profit (MR, TR, MC, TC), Graphical Analysis of Profit/Loss	12	Chapter 11 Homework
Friday	**01/26/24**	**Exam 2**		**5,6,10,11**	***Last Day to Withdraw***
Saturday	01/27/24				
Sunday	01/28/24				
Monday	01/29/24	Firms in Perfectly Competitive Markets	The Shutdown Rule in the SR and in the LR, Entry and Exit of Firms in the LR; Efficiency	12	
Tuesday	01/30/24	Monopolistic Competition	Demand and Marginal Revenue for a Monopolistically Competitive Firm, Maximizing Profit in the SR; Comparison of Monopolistic Competition and Perfect Competition, Product Differentiation	13	Chapter 12 Homework
Wednesday	01/31/24	Monopoly and Antitrust Policy	What is a Monopoly, Where Do Monopolies Come From, Output and Price Choice by a Monopoly; Monopoly and Economic Efficiency, Government Policies	13	
Thursday	02/01/24	FLEXIBLE	Oligopolgy, Game Theory, etc. or Review for Friday Exam		Chapter 13 Homework
Friday	**02/02/24**	**Final Exam**		**Cumulative**	

8. Policies

Course-Specific Policies

Attendance

Absences on religious holidays listed in university calendars are recognized as an excused absence. Nevertheless, you are urged to remind me of your intention to be absent on a particular upcoming holiday. Absences on religious holidays not listed in university calendars, as well as absences due to athletic participation or other extracurricular activities in which you are an official representative of the university, shall be recognized as excused absences when you informs me in writing during the first two weeks of the semester of these planned absences for the semester.

Communication

Announcements with course updates will be posted through Canvas. Students are responsible for checking Canvas regularly to check for any course communications. I encourage all students to set Canvas notifications so that they receive an email when a new announcement is posted.

Students are also welcome to reach out via email (fgentile@udel.edu). Emails must be sent from a student's @udel.edu email account and include the course number (ECON101) in the subject line. Please allow 24 hours for a response before sending a follow-up email.

For academic inquiries, attending office hours or scheduling an appointment is highly recommended as the most effective means of obtaining clarification or asking questions. Additionally, if you encounter any issues such as typos, problems with Canvas due dates, or grading discrepancies, please report them promptly via email, including a screenshot of the identified concern.

Use of Advanced Automated Tools

ChatGPT and other automated tools may be used in this course, however do pay attention to the content received from these tools. Sometimes the information can be incorrect, leading to incorrect answers. If you submit an assignment using this incorrect information, you will not be able to resubmit.

Student Mental Health & Wellbeing

College students often experience things that may interfere with academic success such as academic stress, sleep problems, juggling responsibilities, life events, relationship concerns, or feelings of anxiety, hopelessness, or depression. If you are experiencing any of the above in a way that is negatively impacting your ability to participate fully in the learning activities for this class, I strongly encourage you to get in touch with me. Additionally, I have provided information from other campus-wide units below.

- Contact me
    - If you are struggling with this class, please check-in during office hours or contact me by email at fgentile@udel.edu
- Check-in with your academic advisor or the Assistant Dean for Student Services in your college.
    - If you are struggling in multiple classes, unsure whether you are making the most of your time at UD, or unsure what academic resources are available at UD.
- UD's Center for Counseling & Student Development (CCSD), TimelyCare, and UD Helpline
    - UD's Center for Counseling & Student Development (CCSD) provides cost-free and confidential mental health services promoting psychological wellbeing so that students can be more successful in their academic, personal, and career pursuits. CCSD provides in-person services including walk-in urgent visits, scheduled individual and group counseling, and consultation for students, parents, and faculty.

    - CCSD partners with TimelyCare to provide scheduled counseling and health coaching via telehealth.
    - For 24/7 mental health support, students have the option of calling the UD Helpline at 302-831-1001 or accessing TimelyCare's Talk Now service through the TimelyCare app or online. Visit CCSD's website for additional information and resources.
- UD's Crisis Text Line
    - Text "UDTEXT" (or "STEVE" for students desiring to connect with a professional who specializes in supporting students of color) to 741741 for confidential text message support.
- Division of Student Life
    - Explore the Student Life's Wellbeing webpage for a comprehensive listing of well-being resources, activities, and services available to all students.

UD Academic Policies

The Safety of Our Learning Environment

Student learning can only occur when students and their instructors feel safe, respected, and supported by each other. To ensure that our learning environment is as safe as possible, you are expected to abide by the most up-to-date University of Delaware's COVID-19 Guidelines,

Academic Honesty

Please familiarize yourself with UD policies regarding academic dishonesty. The Academic Honesty Policy states: "Students must be honest and forthright in their academic studies. Students are expected to do their own work and must give proper credit for any work not their own. Students may neither give nor receive unauthorized assistance. Engaging in academic dishonesty, or allowing other students to do the same, corrupts the educational process and diminishes the quality of a University of Delaware degree." View the university's procedures for resolving academic dishonesty concerns. Contact Community Standards & Conflict Resolution at communitystandards@udel.edu or (302) 831-2117.

Harassment, Discrimination, and Sexual Misconduct

Lauren's Promise- I will listen and believe you if someone is threatening you.

Lauren McClusky, a 21-year-old honors student-athlete, was murdered on October 22, 2018, by a man she briefly dated on the University of Utah campus. ***We must all take action to ensure that this never happens again.*** I will listen and believe you if someone is threatening you.

The University of Delaware works to promote an academic and work environment that is free from all forms of discrimination, including harassment and sexual misconduct. As a member of the community, your rights, resources and responsibilities are reflected in the Non-Discrimination, Sexual Misconduct, and Title IX policy. Please familiarize yourself with this policy at the University's Office of Equity & Inclusion's website. You can report any concerns to the University's Office of Equity & Inclusion (302) 831-8063 or at titleixcoordinator@udel.edu. you can report anonymously through UD Police (302) 831-2222 or the EthicsPoint Compliance Hotline.

- Read the full policy
- File a report

Faculty Statement on Disclosures of Instances of Sexual Misconduct

If, at any time during this course, I happen to be made aware that a student may have been the victim of sexual misconduct (including sexual harassment, sexual violence, domestic/dating violence, or stalking), I am a responsible employee, which means I am directed to report any incident of sexual harassment or misconduct to the University's Title IX Coordinator. The Title IX Coordinator will then meet with the student to discuss how the University will respond to the report and the student's rights and options, to offer resources, and to ensure that the student and the campus community are safe. If such a situation is disclosed to me in class, in a paper assignment, or in office hours, I promise to protect your privacy--I will not disclose the incident to anyone but the Title IX Coordinator in a confidential manner.

For more information on Sexual Misconduct policies, where to get help, and reporting information, please refer to www.udel.edu/sexualmisconduct. You can also send an email to the Title IX Coordinator at titleixcoordinator@udel.edu. At UD, we provide 24/7/365 crisis assistance and victim advocacy and counseling. Contact 302-831-1001 to get in touch with a sexual offense support advocate, as well as confidential and anonymous counseling services for other concerns.

Accommodations for Students with Disabilities

Any student who may need disability-related accommodations should contact the Office of Disability Support Services (DSS) office as soon as possible. For more information, please visit Getting Registered at DSS. Contact DSS by phone: 302-831-4643; fax: 302-831-3261; website: www.udel.edu/dss; email: dssoffice@udel.edu; or visit 240 Academy Street, Alison Hall Suite 130 during business hours (8-5 M-F).

Non-Discrimination

The University of Delaware does not discriminate against any person on the basis of race, color, national origin, sex, gender identity or expression, sexual orientation, genetic information, marital status, disability, religion, age, veteran status or any other characteristic protected by applicable law in its employment, educational programs and activities, admissions policies, and scholarship and loan programs as required by Title IX of the Educational Amendments of 1972, the Americans with Disabilities Act of 1990, Section 504 of the Rehabilitation Act of 1973, Title VII of the Civil Rights Act of 1964, and other applicable statutes and University policies. The University of Delaware also prohibits unlawful harassment including sexual harassment and sexual violence.

For inquiries or complaints related to non-discrimination policies, please contact: Office of Equity & Inclusion- oei@udel.edu, (302) 831-8063

For complaints related to Section 504 of the Rehabilitation Act of 1973 and/or the Americans with Disabilities Act, please contact: Office of Disability Support Services, dssoffice@udel.edu, Alison Hall, Suite 130, Newark, DE 19716 (302) 831-4643 OR contact the U.S. Department of Education - Office for Civil Rights